

Hitesh Manani

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SUMMARY

Azure Cloud Engineer with extensive hands-on experience managing, designing, automating, and scaling Azure infrastructure across enterprise and public-sector cloud environments. Strong background across cloud operations, automation, platform delivery, and client-facing implementation, with experience building scalable platform workflows using Terraform and modern DevOps/GitOps practices, ensuring seamless integration of security throughout the engineering lifecycle.

SKILLS

Cloud & Platform: Microsoft Azure (IaaS/PaaS), Kubernetes (AKS), Azure Functions, Azure VMs, Logic Apps, Azure Update Manager, Azure Resource Graph, Azure Cost Management, Cosmos DB, Azure Storage, Platform Engineering, Cloud Security Automation, FinOps, Zero Trust

Infrastructure & Delivery: Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Terraform, Terragrunt, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, GitLab, CI/CD, GitOps, Argo CD, Docker, Azure Container Registry

Security & DevSecOps: Azure Firewall, Azure VNets, NSGs, Application Gateway, Load Balancers, WAF, Entra, RBAC, PIM, Key Vault, Secrets Management, Access Control, Managed Identity, TLS, Azure Backup/Restore, BCDR, Defender for Cloud

Monitoring & Operations: Azure Monitor, Log Analytics, KQL, Datadog, Prometheus, New Relic, Incident Response, RCA, Runbooks, SLA-driven operations, Infrastructure & Application Monitoring, Incident Triage and Alerts, Compliance & Governance

Scripting & Tools: PowerShell, Python, Bash, Git, Postman, Linear, Plane, Jira, Confluence, Notion, Miro

Delivery: Release readiness, stakeholder management, technical demos, customer onboarding, requirements translation, cross-functional execution

WORK EXPERIENCE

Contango (QData), by ADQ

Solutions Engineer | Manager

Abu Dhabi, UAE

December 2025 - Present

Cross-functional platform and product delivery role for 'Q', a sovereign-grade Azure-hosted AI product for board governance across the ADQ ecosystem.

- Architected a new proof-of-concept delivery model for the product on Azure using a shared tenancy model, reducing monthly platform cost from \$15K to \$6K and improving scalability of customer rollouts.
- Designed and automated secure infrastructure provisioning using Terraform and Terragrunt, creating reusable modules for cloud resources. Supported secure, multi-tenant AKS clusters across production and non-production environments.
- Improved weekly production release readiness by building and leading a 5-person product assurance function, owning final signoff, release validation, and client-facing rollout communication.
- Ensured least-privilege access by strengthening granular Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) framework across 6 Azure subscriptions by assisting with Azure Entra ID and Privileged Identity Management (PIM).
- Supported in the implementation of sovereign hub-and-spoke network design, and network micro-segmentation using Azure Firewall and Network Security Groups (NSGs) with deny-by-default policies to isolate critical client workloads and restrict lateral movement.
- Reduced projected Azure spend by a further 10–20% by identifying service redesign opportunities, resource optimisation options, and capacity tuning improvements.
- Served as technical lead in executive and enterprise product demonstrations and value proposition sessions, presenting the product, implementation and adoption strategies to senior stakeholders, translating technical capabilities into business outcomes and risk reduction narratives.
- Maintained continuous liaison with Product Management, converting prospect objections and customer feedback into a prioritised backlog of feature enhancements.
- Turned stakeholder requirements into engineering-ready delivery items by writing user stories, acceptance criteria, test cases, and Definition of Done for product enhancements and fixes.
- Improved product delivery execution by managing backlog priorities across Linear and Plane, tracking bugs, blockers, enhancements, and sprint readiness with product, engineering, and platform teams.

Bespin Global, an e& enterprise company

Cloud Engineer (Managed Services)

Abu Dhabi, UAE

November 2022 - November 2025

Cloud operations engineer supporting managed Azure environments for enterprise and public-sector customers.

- Architected and deployed an event-driven Azure VM patching automation using Event Hub, Logic Apps, Azure Update Manager, Azure Resource Graph, and Managed Identity that auto-started deallocated VMs, creating pre-patch restore points or OS/Data-disk snapshots.
- Added a post-patch reporting pipeline to generate detailed post-patch reports; reduced manual workload by ~1.5–2.0 hrs per patch (~100+ hrs/month at ~50 cycles), and removed dependency on manual ITSM triggers through event-driven execution.
- Engineered failure scopes, idempotency, and concurrency controls to avoid ARM throttling; standardised runbooks across multi-subscription customers.

- Supported Azure Firewall operations across customer environments, including rule/policy updates, connectivity troubleshooting, traffic-flow validation, log review, and security remediation coordination.
- Ran recurring Disaster Recovery (DR) and backup/restore drills across managed customers, executed planned failover/failback, and published playbooks with post-drill improvements; nominated for Q3 Employee Recognition in Customer Impact for coordinating a customer disaster recovery exercise across technical teams and stakeholders.
- Improved cloud security posture across managed environments, by 10–15% average Secure Score increase, by using Microsoft Defender for Cloud to identify, prioritise, and remediate recommendations across identity, compute, networking, storage, and baseline hardening controls.
- Managed Azure Backup operations for production workloads by configuring Recovery Services Vaults, backup and retention policies, monitoring backup job health, validating restores, and supporting disaster recovery testing across customer environments.
- Served as first escalation point for high-priority infrastructure and security incidents, triaging critical alerts, executing initial remediation, coordinating L2/vendor escalation, communicating with customers, and driving RCA to meet SLAs and prevent recurrence.
- Authored SOPs/runbooks for patching, DR, backup/restore, and incident response; improved 24/7 shift handoffs and MTTR.
- Deployed and configured New Relic monitoring for customer environments, including infrastructure/application monitoring agents, NRQL dashboards, alert conditions, and service health views for availability, patching, and performance tracking.
- Fine-tuned alerts in New Relic/Datadog, cutting alert fatigue by ~38% and speeding escalations; conducted security remediation exercises to raise secure scores by 10–15% on average.
- Developed automation scripts in PowerShell and Python for Azure and M365, saving ~20 staff hours/week.
- Analysed spend with Azure Cost Management; recommended budgeting, Reservations/Savings Plans and workload optimisations to reduce client operational costs.

Bespinn Global, an e& enterprise company

Cloud Engineer/DevOps Intern

Abu Dhabi, UAE

September 2022 - November 2022

- Built HA Azure environments aligned to the Well-Architected Framework; implemented initial CI/CD with Azure DevOps, reducing deployment time by ~40%.

EDUCATION

Heriot-Watt University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (First Class Honours)

Awards: 3 x Deputy Principal's Award Recipient

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft - Azure Administrator (AZ-104)

Microsoft - Azure Network Engineer (AZ-700)

Microsoft - Security, Compliance, and Identity Fundamentals (SC-900)

Microsoft - Azure AI Engineer (AI-102)

Microsoft - Azure Network Security Ninja

Microsoft AI Product Manager Professional

Microsoft Sales: Threat Protection - Proficient

IPMA: Project Management Fundamental

PROJECTS

Azure Microservices Delivery Platform on AKS

github.com/hiteshmanani/aks-microservices-cicd-gitops

- Built end-to-end CI/CD for an N-tier microservices application by creating Azure DevOps pipelines to containerise service-specific changes made to various microservices, pushed versioned images to Azure Container Registry, and deployed workloads to Azure Kubernetes Service.
- Automated build and release workflows for 3 independently deployable microservices by configuring separate Azure Pipelines with path-based triggers, Docker image builds, ACR pushes, and Kubernetes manifest update stages.
- Implemented GitOps-based continuous delivery on AKS by configuring Argo CD to monitor Kubernetes manifests in Git and automatically reconcile application changes into the cluster.
- Deployed a multi-tier containerised workload on AKS by configuring Kubernetes Deployment and Service manifests for a Python/Flask frontend, Node.js results service, .NET background worker, Redis cache, and PostgreSQL database.
- Integrated Azure DevOps, ACR, AKS, Kubernetes, and Argo CD into a single delivery workflow by connecting code changes to container builds, image registry updates, manifest versioning, and cluster synchronisation.

Serverless Azure Portfolio Platform

www.hiteshmanani.com | github.com/hiteshmanani/azure-cloud-resume

- Deployed a Hugo-based personal portfolio on Azure Storage Static Website, delivered through Cloudflare DNS/CDN/TLS with custom domain, HTTPS enforcement, and apex-to-www redirect.
- Implemented a three-tier serverless visitor counter using JavaScript, Azure Functions in Python, and Azure Cosmos DB Table API, with API-mediated data access and domain-restricted CORS.
- Automated frontend, backend and infrastructure deployment using GitHub Actions and Terraform, including site publishing, smoke tests, and Azure resource deployments.
- Applied security-aware cloud practices by applying TLS enforcement, Azure RBAC/data-plane permissions, CORS restrictions, secrets management, and frontend/API/database separation.

INVOLVEMENT

Microsoft Reactor MEA, AWS User Group UAE, Volunteers.ae, ProductTank UAE, 80000hours.org, Consultants for Impact